

10.2 Online Virus / Trojan Scans

All viruses are bad. Some are worse, and can render your anti-virus software useless. Let's say you haven't updated your anti-virus software, and a new virus that disables anti-virus programs strikes. It would not let you install another anti-virus either. This is where online virus scans come in handy. Many anti-virus makers have an online virus scan facility. In case of an emergency, you can use the following links:

Housecall

<http://housecall.trendmicro.com>

This service from Trend Micro is one of the oldest and most well-known online scanning services.

BitDefender

www.bitdefender.com/scan8/ie.html

From the site, "BitDefender Online Scanner is a fully-functional anti-virus product. It features all required elements for thorough anti-virus scanning and effective cleaning: it scans your system's memory, all files, folders and drives' boot sectors, providing you with the option to automatically clean the infected files."

PC-Pitstop

www.pcpitstop.com/antivirus/AVLoad.asp

Pcpitstop.com offers a variety of tests besides an anti-virus scan—Internet speed, privacy scan, spyware scan, a "quick scan," "Exterminate", driver scan, disk health, and more.

Jotti.org

<http://virusscan.jotti.org>

You can submit a file here for an anti-virus test. Useful if you've received a file from someone and you don't have an anti-virus (or one that's not updated.)

Windowsecurity.com

www.windowsecurity.com/trojanscan